

Bible

Old Testament
Church History
New Testament
Bible History





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Old Testament: Grades 7-12, New Testament: Grade 9, Church History: Grades 7-9, Bible History: Grade 9

About Old Testament: Grades 7-12

From 7th grade through high school, students read through the OT chronologically. For 2026-2027 they read 2 Samuel-I Kings, 1 & 2 Chronicles, Psalms and Proverbs (selections) and Ecclesiastes. 12th grade will also read Song of Solomon. With the aid of study Bible notes and selections from study helps such as the Old Testament Today or The Bible Project, this course allows students to meditate on Scripture and engage with the historical and cultural context of the Bible when it was written, as well as the way the OT continues to be relevant as God's word today.

About Church History: Grades 7-9

Students read about important events and influential people from Church History using biographies and narrative-driven overviews of the time period. In this course, students delve into the 19th century and learn the stories of a variety of Christians.

About New Testament: Grade 9

Each year in High School, students read one of the gospels along with several other New Testament epistles. For 2026-2027, they read the gospel of Luke along with Galatians, Philippians, and Colossians. Using their study Bibles and other resources, students encounter scripture and seek to understand the cultural, historical, and theological context of their readings in order to more deeply appreciate the richness of the Bible and the humility needed in order to live out God's word today.

About Bible History: Grade 9

This course uses the book God's Big Picture to give students a zoomed-out view of Bible history and show the outline of God's Kingdom plan from beginning to end.



Placement & Combining Tips

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

Students in Grades 7-12 read the same passages of Scripture, but the lesson plans include a variety of discussion questions and extra study helps differentiated by grade to help students engage at various depths. This makes these lessons flexible for individual students and/or a multi-age context. Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the narratives and overarching story of the OT.

Church History: Grades 7-9

Can be combined with Grades 5-6.

New Testament: Grade 9

Appropriate for any HS grades. Students new to reading the Bible for themselves or unused to commentaries or study notes may find the lessons in Grades 7-8 a gentler introduction to these study practices.

Bible History: Grade 9

Appropriate for any HS grades.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12 2 times/week 30 min 2 times/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition Old Testament Today NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture ESV Concise Study Bible
7-9	Church History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	Spurgeon: A Biography Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words
9	New Testament: Grade 9 1 time/week 30 min	NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey Luke for Everyone
9	Bible History: Grade 9 1 time/week 30 min	God's Big Picture: Tracing the Storyline of the Bible

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 9				
Bible History: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Bible History: Grade 9

Check the Extra Helpings for grades 9-12 resources for devotional reading, Sunday reading, seasonal reading, and more.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Bible: Grade 9

Old Testament: Grades 7-12



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



Old Testament Today



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



ESV Concise Study Bible

Church History: Grades 7-9



Spurgeon: A Biography



Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward



An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

New Testament: Grade 9



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Luke for Everyone

Bible History: Grade 9



God's Big Picture: Tracing the Storyline of the Bible



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Bible: Grade 9

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)

Church History: Grades 7-9

∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Bible: Grade 9

How To Approach



Recap

Take a moment to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic.



Read

Read the passage assigned or read for the number of minutes allocated. If a book is challenging for you, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently now and then to make sure you are tracking. Or you could listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along. You may also want to read aloud to yourself. If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride! Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your Commonplace Book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. You might want to set a timer to keep yourself on track, so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

Read notes in your Study Bible or commentary. Look up places mentioned in the text in your Bible atlas. Add something to your Book of Centuries or Commonplace Book. Jot down additional reflections and thoughts in your Bible notebook or share with others.



Teacher Note

Read over the lesson plans to familiarize yourself with the content for accountability and interest. If doing the lessons together, use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to rouse students' interest before reading. You may also highlight one or two unfamiliar terms if needed. If in a classroom context, you may choose to leave larger doctrinal conversations for students to have with their parents at home.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: Bible, Old Testament Today, notebook

→ INTRO (FOR GRADES 7-12)

This year you will be reading 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 1 & 2 Chronicles, selections of Psalms, Proverbs, and Ecclesiastes. You will be reading the passages chronologically, or in the order of the events. "The goal of studying the Bible chronologically is not to replace the time-honored canonical arrangement, but instead to honor time as a setting in which the biblical record appeared. Readers who study the Bible this way will return to their traditional Bibles better equipped to read them. Acquiring a sense of the flow of the Bible's story will put flesh and blood on its message" (from Chronological Guide to the Bible).

1. Your ESV Concise Study Bible (Grades 7-8) or Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible (Grades 9-12) will have maps, articles, and notes to help you along the way. If you have a question about a specific verse, see if there is a note about that verse below the text.
2. Use your Student Bible Atlas or atlas in your Bible to locate places as needed.
3. We will also utilize Old Testament Today and the Bible Project website as a handbook for helping us understand the background information we need to be informed readers. Look up the chapter of the Bible book you are reading in OT Today for any interesting sections you have not read before. Similarly, do a search at the Bible Project Website for the book you are reading and see what interesting articles or videos they have available when you have time in a lesson.

→ VIEW

1. Throughout the year, you will watch short videos of Dr. John Walton, the co-author of OT Today. The videos were created specifically for Alveary students. We hope they help you understand the Bible better.
2. You will be reading selections from the Psalms throughout the year. Watch this video to learn more about the Psalms.

∞ Video Link: Overview of the Psalms

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read selections from the Psalms.

∞ Image Link: Psalms Overview Poster

→ READ, NARRATE & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.367-370 "To understand what" - "individual and nation."
2. Psalms 79-82

The psalms are difficult to tie to a specific historical context. They are the worship songs of Israel and are intended to apply to the needs of all worshippers across time. Some psalms do have historical superscriptions that make it possible to associate them with specific events, but these make up only about 10% of all the psalms. Another criterion is to place the psalms ascribed to David (or Solomon or Moses) during the life of that person. A second criterion is to place Psalms according to their type (from the Chronological Guide to the Bible).

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Bible Project Overview of the Psalms

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Luke for Everyone, notebook

→ INTRO

Each year in HS, we will be reading one of the Gospels along with our study of the rest of the New Testament books. This year, we will be

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

These two journal options with different designs contain only the Bible book text and space to write. You may find them a good choice for your studies this year, as you can underline, highlight, or make notes right on the page.



Term 1

reading Luke along with Galatians, Philippians, and Colossians. It is helpful to be continually reminded of who Jesus is and how he interacted with people. The Gospel accounts were designed to be read many times. There will be insights gained that you would only pick up after multiple readings and by paying attention to repeated words and themes.

We will make use of the Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible notes and maps, Introducing the New Testament (selections), a Luke commentary (selections), and some Bible Project videos to help us understand what Luke and Paul are saying to their audiences. Then we can think about what new thoughts about God we gain in the process. You do not need to read all the study notes for all the verses. Pick and choose based on which verses you have questions about. Use a digital or physical notebook to record your thoughts as you work your way through the readings.

→ VIEW & NARRATE

Today and over the next few weeks, we will set the stage for reading Luke and the Epistles by gaining some context. Narrate silently in your head or by talking to yourself to go over the main points. Write down a few of them in your journal.

∞ Video Link: How to Read the New Testament

→ READ & NARRATE

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.1 p.17-24

Make a list with a short description of the rulers in Palestine at the time of Jesus.

→ MAP WORK

When places are named in the text, refer to a map in the Study Bible or in the Introducing the NT book. Finding the places on the map is very helpful for seeing the stories in the context of the land. Sketching your own maps of journeys or regions can be helpful too.

∞ Link: ESV Scripture Journal Luke

∞ Link: ESV Illuminated Scripture Journal Luke

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ INTRO

Last year, we read through I Chronicles 16. Today, we will keep moving forward chronologically.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Davidic Covenant

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Read about 1-2 Chronicles p.223-224 in OT Today.
2. Psalm 83
3. I Chronicles 17

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this summary of the whole OT in under 13 minutes.

∞ Video Link: OT Summary

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

William Wilberforce

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

1. This year, we are learning about people who lived during the 19th century (1800-1900). We will read how these Christians lived out Jesus' commands. When Jesus was asked what the greatest command was, he replied, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all

• IMPORTANT DATES

1759-1833 - William Wilberforce
1833 - Slave Trade was abolished in England

• DEFINITIONS

diminutive: (p.93) small size

• EXTRA HELPING

You can listen to the hymn



Term 1

your soul and with all your mind. This is the great and first commandment. And a second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself." (Matthew 22:37-39)

2. Today, you will read about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. Parliament consisted of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of a total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the commerce and national security of Great Britain.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Painting of William Wilberforce

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-100 "The striking of" - "after this event."

- Wilberforce had considered withdrawing from public life for the sake of his faith. However, his pastor John Newton advised him, "It is hoped and believed that the Lord has raised you up for the good of his church and for the good of the nation." What do you think about that advice?

Amazing Grace and follow along with the lyrics on p.100.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace

WEEK 1 30m Bible History: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

📄 Materials: God's Big Picture

→ INTRO

You will be reading God's Big Picture slowly over the entire year. Take a minute to acquaint yourself with the structure of the book. Notice the charts included in the text; don't skip these as you read the assigned selections—they are important supports. You may wish to read through the Bible study section at the end of each chapter but they are not generally assigned.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

God's Big Picture p.9-16

Preface and Introduction up to middle of p.16

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 3

📄 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and I Chronicles last time?

→ VIEW

When you read the Bible chronologically, you switch back and forth between 1-2 Samuel, 1-2 Chronicles, and 1-2 Kings. Dr. Walton will explain what the differences are between those books, even though they are telling about the same time period.

∞ Video Link: Differences Between Two Accounts of Israelite History

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Read about 1-2 Samuel in OT Today p.204-208.
2. Psalm 88
3. 2 Samuel 8-9



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ READ

Luke 1

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Talk over to yourself what you just read. Then, respond to what you read by putting down a few of your thoughts or questions. Just as in nature study, when we ask questions such as, "What do I notice? What do I wonder? What does this remind me of?" we can ask the same questions about what we read.

→ READ

Pick one of the Luke for Everyone readings discussing verses from Luke 1. Jot down any new insights or thoughts.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.1 p.31-32 "Social Systems" - "more than they needed."

Write a sentence summarizing the mindset of the NT world towards wealth and poverty.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

Instead of reading Luke for some of the lessons, consider watching and listening to Luke via the LUMO Project, which only uses the actual text of Luke but has people acting while it is read. There are many versions and many languages available. You might consider this resource for your modern language studies, too. However, be sure to ask yourself, "What did the film add visually that the Gospel text itself did not explicitly say?" as any visualization project requires interpretive decisions to be made.

∞ Video Links:

Lumo Project Luke 1:1-38

Lumo Project Luke 1:39-80

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.12-15 "A plotline traces" - "these three terms."
2. ∞ Video Link: Big Ideas and Plotlines

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 10-11

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Fact Files: The Beacons of Freedom and Justice

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

Give a brief account of what you remember about William Wilberforce.

→ INTRO

In this section, "The Beacons of Freedom and Justice," you will be introduced to four historical figures who were motivated by their Christian faith to help others find freedom and justice. The first person lived in the 1700's, so that is the century before the time period we are studying this year.

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.101-102 "Freedom is a word" - "should be applauded."
 2. Watch this video that tells about Oglethorpe's role in the founding of Georgia and then takes us up to the 19th century.
- ∞ Video Link: Founding of Georgia Colony

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

● IMPORTANT DATES

1733 - James Oglethorpe founded the colony of Georgia
 1772 - John Newton pens Amazing Grace
 1839 - Frederick Douglas becomes a licensed preacher
 1850-1860 - Harriet Tubman's Underground Railroad Work

● EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about John Newton, the author of Amazing Grace
 ∞ **Article Link:** The Story of John Newton
 ∞ **Video Link:** Newton's Grace: The True Story of Amazing Grace



Term 1

1. p.102-104 "Another Englishman who" - "Thee Are Spoken."
 2. p.104-107 "While men like" - "fight for themselves."
 3. Read this article to learn more about Harriet Tubman.
- ∞ Article Link: Black Moses

WEEK 2 30m Bible History: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Materials: God's Big Picture

→ READ

p.16-23, continuing Introduction

→ WRITE

Reflect on Fig.5 (p.22); consider how this applied to your Old Testament readings last year. Keep it in mind as you read this year's selections, perhaps using it as the basis for some of your Bible journal writings during other Bible lessons.

→ READ

Use any extra lesson time today to finish other Bible lessons or do some reading from books suggested in Extra Helpings.

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.19-21 "Confidence in the Results" - "hermeneutics are insufficient."
2. ∞ Video Link: Defective Views of God

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. 2 Samuel 12
2. Psalm 51

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Luke 2-3

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Talk over to yourself what you just read. Then, respond to what you read by putting down a few of your thoughts or questions.

→ READ

Choose a reading from Luke 2-3 in Luke for Everyone to read. Write down any thoughts.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.1 p.32-33 "Patronage and Loyalty" - "to serve (faith)."

Write a sentence summarizing the mindset of the NT world towards patronage and loyalty.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

The Bible Project has an app with a weekly playlist to go deeper into many topics for continued study.

∞ Info Link: Bible Project App



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. Read OT Today p.9-12 "Most people come" - "the Old Testament."
2. ∞ Video Link: Tapestry Illustration

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 13

WEEK 3 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Emilie Mallet

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

What do you remember about our last reading?

→ INTRO

Today, you will read about a French lady from the 1800s who may be unknown to you but has an interesting story of love and service to those in need. She could have just enjoyed her upper-class lifestyle but wanted to show the love of Christ to others.

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Emilie Mallet
2. The Pantheon in Paris (not to be confused with the Pantheon in Rome) is mentioned in this chapter. It is a mausoleum or monument that houses the remains of distinguished French citizens,
∞ Image Link: Pantheon in Paris

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.109-117 "The shrieks could" - "margins of society."
2. Read these excerpts from the biography A Christian woman; being the life of Mme. Jules Mallet, translated by Mrs. H.N. Goodhart. Most of them are journal entries from Emilie about the circumstances in Paris.
∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from A Christian Woman

- What did you learn about Emilie from her journal entries?

→ VIEW

Have you seen Toile de Jouy fabric before? It is actually French for "cloth from Jouy." It was produced by Emilie's father and can still be found today on decorative fabrics and wallpaper.
∞ Image Link: Toile de Jouy

• DEFINITIONS

Cholera: (p.109) a disease that is caused by bacteria through water or food that has been tainted. Cholera can cause serious diarrhea and dehydration and can be fatal.

aristocracy: (p.111) upper class usually made up of a hereditary nobility

• IMPORTANT DATES

1832 - Emilie Mallet begins her charity work for young children and prisoners

WEEK 3 30m Bible History: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

Materials: God's Big Picture

→ READ

p.23-26, continuing Introduction

→ NARRATE

Silently go over what you read as if you were telling someone about it.